



RELATIVE CLAUSES 1



Scan to review worksheet

Expemo code:

1HL1-M1LF-4FD



1

Presentation

Study the following table.

	Use and examples
who	We use who when we are talking about people: • Do you know the woman who is standing over there?
which	We use which when we are talking about things: • I've never eaten a pizza which tastes so good!
where	We use where when we are talking about place: • I can't remember the name of the hotel where we stayed.
whose	We use whose instead of his/her/their: • I met a guy whose name was Obama. (= I met a guy. His name was Obama.)
that	We can use that instead of who or which : • Do you know the woman that is standing over there? • I've never eaten a pizza that tastes so good!



Important points

1. **That** is more usual than **which** in these types of relative clauses.

2. We do not use **what** in relative clauses.

- I've never eaten a pizza ~~what~~ **that** tastes so good!

What = 'the thing(s) that'

- **What** I wanted was out of stock.
- I can't decide **what** to buy.

3. When **who/that/which** is the object of the verb, we can leave it out:

- They didn't have the shirt **that** I wanted to buy.
- They didn't have the shirt I wanted to buy.

In the above sentence, **that** (= the shirt) is the object of the verb *wanted*. But if **who/that/which** is the subject of the verb, we cannot leave it out:

- Do you know the woman **who** is standing over there?
(NOT: Do you know the woman is standing over there?)



2

Practice 1

Make one sentence or question from two like in the example.

The boy is my nephew. He is playing with the ball.

→ The boy who/that is playing with the ball is my nephew.

1. The police caught the criminal. He stole my car.

2. The athlete was caught taking drugs. He will be punished.

3. The building was hit by an earthquake. It is still standing.

4. I saw the woman. Her brother works with me.

5. Somebody called me. He was a salesman.

6. A pen was on my desk. Have you seen it?

7. The woman lives next door to me. She has been learning English for 10 years.



3

Practice 2

Now do the same with the sentences below. If a sentence does not require who/which/that/where etc., leave it out.

1. We stayed at a hotel. It was a very cheap hotel.

2. I work with a few people. You might know them.

3. I lent you some money. Have you got it?

4. The milk has gone bad. It is still in the fridge.

5. Last night, we went to a restaurant. It serves Italian food.

6. I'm going to visit a town. I was born there.

7. Tom is a computer scientist. He has a lot of experience.

8. I sent you an email. Have you received it?

9. You like the girl's dog. Have you heard from her?

10. The cake was delicious. You baked it yesterday.



4

Practice 3: Pair work

Study the following examples with a partner. Take turns creating similar pairs of sentences and asking the other person to combine them using relative clauses.

Examples:

1) The book is on the table. It belongs to Sarah.

→ The book **that** is on the table belongs to Sarah.

2) The girl is wearing a red dress. She is singing on the stage.

→ The girl **who** is wearing a red dress is singing on the stage.

3) The book is very interesting. I borrowed it from the library.

→ The book **that** I borrowed from the library is very interesting.

4) I bought a new phone. It has a great camera.

→ The new phone I bought **has** a great camera.

1.

→

2.

→

3.

→

4.

→



5

Cue Cards: Discussion**Subtitle for the section****Using Relative Clauses: Set 1****1) Family and Friends**

Describe a family member who has influenced you a lot.

Example: "The person who has influenced me the most is my grandmother, who always gives great advice."

2) Travel and Holidays

Talk about a holiday experience that you will never forget.

Example: "The holiday that I will never forget is the one we spent in Italy, where we visited many historical sites."

3) Entertainment

Describe a film or TV show that you recently watched and enjoyed.

Example: "The film that I recently watched and enjoyed is 'Inception,' which has an incredibly complex and engaging storyline."

4) School and Education

Discuss a book or article that you have read recently.

Example: "The book that I read recently is 'Harry Potter,' which is full of magic and adventure."

Using Relative Clauses: Set 2



1) Technology

Describe a gadget that you use every day and cannot live without.

Example: "The gadget that I use every day is my smartphone, which keeps me connected to my friends and family."

2) Food and Cooking

Discuss a dish that you enjoy cooking or eating.

Example: "The dish that I enjoy cooking the most is spaghetti carbonara, which is both delicious and easy to make."

3) Sports and Exercise

Talk about a sport that you enjoy playing or watching.

Example: "The sport that I enjoy playing the most is basketball, which helps me stay fit and active."

4) Nature and Environment

Describe a place in nature that you love visiting.

Example: "The place in nature that I love visiting is the beach, where I can relax and enjoy the sound of the waves."



Key

1. Presentation

5 mins.

Go over the rules of using relative clauses with the class. Explain any items that are unclear or confusing at this stage.

2. Practice 1

5 mins.

Students create sentences using relative clauses and the provided prompts.

1. The police caught the criminal who/that stole my car.
2. The athlete who/that was caught taking drugs will be punished.
3. The building which/that was hit by an earthquake is still standing.
4. I saw the woman whose brother works with me.
5. The person who/that called me was a salesman.
6. Have you seen the pen which/that was on my desk?
7. The woman who/that lives next door to me has been learning English for 10 years.

3. Practice 2

5 mins.

This exercise provides further practice with sentence formation and relative clauses covered in the previous tasks. Circulate and help as needed.

1. The hotel we stayed at was a very cheap hotel.
2. I work with a few people you might know.
3. Have you got the money I lent you?
4. The milk which/that has gone bad is still in the fridge.
5. Last night, we went to a restaurant which/that serves Italian food.
6. I'm going to visit the town where I was born.
7. Tom is a computer scientist who/that has a lot of experience.
8. Have you received the email I sent you?
9. Have you heard from the girl whose dog you like?
10. The cake that/which you baked yesterday was delicious.

4. Practice 3: Pair work

10 mins.

This task can be done in pairs or in small groups - in this case, try to split the students into an even number of groups. Students can write their prompts down and exchange the papers, first to complete the sentences and then again to check.



5. Cue Cards: Discussion

10-15 mins.

Set 1: Encourage students to use additional relative pronouns like "whose" and "whom" if appropriate.

Monitor the class during the activity to assist with any difficulties and provide on-the-spot corrections.

Adjust the difficulty of the task by providing more complex prompts for advanced students or simplifying for those who need more support.

Set 2: Distribute the new set of cue cards to the students. Each student or pair of students will receive one card.

Instruct the students to create sentences or short paragraphs using the prompts on the cards, making sure to include relative clauses.

Encourage students to be creative and share personal experiences or opinions related to the prompts.

Sharing and Feedback (10 mins)

After students have created their sentences, ask them to share their sentences with the class or in small groups.

Provide feedback on their use of relative clauses, correcting any mistakes and praising correct usage.

Wrap-Up (5 mins)

Summarise the lesson by highlighting the importance of relative clauses in making sentences more descriptive and informative.

Answer any remaining questions students may have about the topic.